

Better Is Available

Once you get a clear picture of your starting point, you'll probably have one of three reactions. I discussed these in detail in my book *Retire Inspired*, but I'll quickly recap them here:

1. *Oh, crap!* This is the realization that you're in pretty bad shape. If your net worth is a negative number, these will probably be the first words out of your mouth.
2. *Oh, boy!* This is the reaction when you see you've got the ball rolling, but you still have a long way to go. This is where you wipe your forehead, dig in, and get back to work.
3. *Oh, yeah!* If you've been diligent about saving and investing for a while, your net worth may make you jump out of your chair and high-five your spouse. This is the realization that you're doing great so far and you're on pace for a sweet finish-line victory.

Most of the people who read this book will have one of the first two reactions when they look at their net worth for the first time—and that's okay. Remember, wealthy people don't lie to themselves or make excuses for screwing things up. They face the truth, admit that they've made some mistakes, own them, and move on. That's what I want you to do right now.

Whatever your net worth reveals, no matter how awesome or how terrible things look today, remember this statement: *better is available*. Take a deep breath and say that out loud. *Better is available*. If you're standing in a deep hole, you've got nowhere to go but up. If you're standing at the top of a mountain, you can go climb a higher mountain. You can *always* improve your situation; you just have to stay hungry, take responsibility for where you *are* and where you want to *be*, and be willing to go after it. When you truly believe better is available for you, you're doing two things: First, you're accepting the fact that something better is out there. You're